



RESOURCE LIBRARY · VOLUME 3

Caregiver Reflection Sheets

When one person is injured, the whole family is affected. These worksheets are for the ones who hold everything together — and rarely get asked how they're doing.

COREY FURNIVAL, SSW, CCTP

HEALING BEYOND DIAGNOSIS INITIATIVE

"Recovery is not returning to who you were.
Recovery is learning who you are now."

— Beyond Diagnosis Theory™



The Caregiver's Invisible Burden

You matter too — even when nobody remembers to say it

Over 8 million Canadians provide unpaid care to a family member or friend. Caregivers experience higher rates of anxiety, depression, burnout, compassion fatigue, sleep disturbances, and social isolation. And yet — most caregivers never ask for help, because they've convinced themselves that their needs come last.

The Things Nobody Tells Caregivers

Check the ones that feel true for you:

- ☐ Nobody asks how I'm doing — they only ask about the person I care for
- ☐ I feel guilty when I take time for myself
- ☐ I've lost parts of myself in this role
- ☐ I'm exhausted but I can't stop
- ☐ I love the person I care for — and sometimes I resent the situation
- ☐ I grieve the relationship we used to have
- ☐ I feel invisible
- ☐ I don't know who I am outside of being a caregiver
- ☐ I'm afraid to admit that I'm not okay

If you checked even one box — this workbook is for you. And you deserve every page of it.



Caregiver Burnout Self-Assessment

Honest check-in — no judgment, just awareness

Rate each statement based on the last 2 weeks. Be honest — this is for you, not anyone else.

STATEMENT	NEVER	RARELY	SOMETIMES	OFTEN	ALWAYS
I feel physically exhausted					
I feel emotionally drained					
I have trouble sleeping					
I feel resentful or angry					
I've withdrawn from friends/family					
I neglect my own health					
I feel hopeless about the future					
I feel guilty when I'm not caregiving					
I feel like I'm losing myself					
I cry more than usual					
I snap at people I love					
I feel like nobody understands					

WHAT THIS TELLS YOU

If you marked "Often" or "Always" on 3 or more items, you may be experiencing burnout. This is not a failure — it's a signal that you need and deserve support. Talk to someone. You've been strong long enough to also be honest.



Compassion Fatigue Check-In

When caring for others starts costing you your own well-being

Compassion fatigue is different from burnout. Burnout is about exhaustion. Compassion fatigue is about emotional depletion — when you've given so much empathy that you have nothing left. You still care, but your body and mind can't sustain it.

Warning Signs

Check any you've noticed in yourself recently:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Feeling numb or emotionally flat | ☐ Avoiding emotional conversations |
| ☐ Dreading caregiving tasks you used to handle | ☐ Chronic headaches, stomach issues, tension |
| ☐ Difficulty feeling empathy | ☐ Increased use of food, alcohol, screens to cope |
| ☐ Intrusive thoughts or nightmares | ☐ Feeling disconnected from your own life |
| ☐ Hypervigilance — always on alert | ☐ Wondering "what's the point?" |

REFLECTION

When did you first notice these signs? What was happening at the time?

What's one thing you could do this week to begin refilling your own cup?



The Guilt Inventory

Naming the guilt so it stops running your life

Caregiver guilt is one of the most powerful — and most destructive — emotions. You feel guilty for resting, for being frustrated, for wanting your old life back, for not doing enough. This exercise helps you look at your guilt honestly.

My Guilt List

Write down every guilt you carry as a caregiver. Don't filter. Don't judge. Just write.

I FEEL GUILTY ABOUT...	IS THIS FAIR TO MYSELF?	WHAT WOULD I SAY TO A FRIEND CARRYING THIS?

The last column is the truth. The things you'd say to a friend? Those are the things you need to say to yourself. You deserve the same compassion you give everyone else.

ONE PERMISSION I'M GIVING MYSELF TODAY



Setting Boundaries Without Guilt

Boundaries aren't selfish — they're survival

Many caregivers believe that setting boundaries means they don't care enough. The opposite is true. Boundaries protect your ability to keep caring. Without them, you burn out — and then nobody gets what they need.

Where Do I Need Boundaries?

PHYSICAL BOUNDARIES

Sleep, rest, personal space, health appointments

What physical boundary do I need to set?

EMOTIONAL BOUNDARIES

Conversations that drain you, expectations from others, guilt-driven tasks

What emotional boundary do I need to set?

TIME BOUNDARIES

Personal time, hobbies, relationships outside caregiving

What time boundary do I need to set?

SOCIAL BOUNDARIES

People who drain you, unsolicited advice, obligations you can't sustain

What social boundary do I need to set?

MY BOUNDARY SCRIPT

Write one boundary you need to communicate and how you would say it:

The boundary:

How I'll say it:



Your Self-Care Audit

Not bubble baths and candles — real, practical self-preservation

Self-care for caregivers isn't luxury — it's infrastructure. Rate how you're doing in each area right now (1 = neglected, 5 = healthy).

AREA	1	2	3	4	5	ONE THING I COULD DO
Sleep						
Nutrition						
Movement / Exercise						
Social Connection						
Emotional Processing						
Personal Time						
Medical Care for Myself						
Joy / Fun						
Spiritual / Meaning						

MY TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS WEEK

Pick the 3 areas scoring lowest. What's one small, realistic action for each?

"You cannot pour from an empty cup — but you also cannot pour from a cup that's cracked. Taking care of yourself isn't selfish. It's structural."

— Healing Beyond Diagnosis Initiative



Weekly Caregiver Check-In

A simple weekly practice to stay connected to yourself

Print this page and complete it once a week. It takes 5 minutes. You're worth 5 minutes.

Week of: _____

HOW AM I REALLY DOING?

1	2	3	4	5
Struggling	Barely holding on	Getting by	Doing okay	Actually good

THIS WEEK'S HIGHS

Something good that happened — no matter how small

THIS WEEK'S LOWS

Something that was hard — be honest

WHAT DID I DO FOR MYSELF?

WHAT DO I NEED NEXT WEEK?

ONE THING I'M PROUD OF THIS WEEK

ANYTHING I NEED TO LET GO OF?
